

Exercise 2.6: User Authentication in Django

Learning Goals

- Create authentication for your web application
- Use GET and POST methods
- Password protect your web application's views

Reflection Questions

1. In your own words, write down the importance of incorporating authentication into an application. You can take an example application to explain your answer.
 - Nowadays with how prevalent data and identity theft is, it's important to implement authentication in order to protect personal data and restrict views from certain users. Using authentication can help restrict and control access to what information can be seen and with which is interacted. For example, one user would be able to access the recipe app and delete user information or their recipes.
2. In your own words, explain the steps you should take to create a login for your Django web application.
 - First a view needs to be created where we import authenticate, login, and AuthenticationForm and write the logic for what happens when the user tries to login. Then we'll map and register the URLs and protect views by requiring authentication to load. Once set up, create the html template for the login view.
3. Look up the following three Django functions on Django's official documentation and/or other trusted sources and write a brief description of each.

Function	Description
authenticate()	Used to verify a set of credentials as keyword arguments like username and password and checks them against each authentication backend.
redirect()	A utility that allows you to perform an HTTP redirect often used in views to redirect from one URL to another.
include()	Adds URLs from the apps directory to the main urls.py file in the project directory.